

Licence and Open-Source Summary

The Hackles Kit

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org · October 2026

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This summary helps a purchasing office or library decide what it may do with the kit. It is a plain-language reading, not legal advice, and counsel has not reviewed it. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM] The full licence texts are in the companion file 05b_License_Texts_Appendix.

Two layers of rights

LAYER	WHAT IT COVERS	LICENCE	WHAT YOU MAY DO
Lesson text and teaching materials	Teacher guides, student books, scripts, worksheets, letters, checklists, assessment forms, this Admin Pack	Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial 4.0 International (CC BY-NC 4.0)	Copy, print, share and adapt for non-commercial use, with credit, a link to the licence, and a note if you changed anything
The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork	The word Hackles, logos, the mascot Hackle, the cast of children, and illustrations	Reserved. Not under Creative Commons	Print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use. Anything else (changing them, using them on products, merchandise, ads, or in a way that suggests endorsement) needs written permission
Third-party fonts	Fraunces, Source Serif 4, Caveat, Special Elite	SIL Open Font License 1.1 (first three); Apache License 2.0 (Special Elite)	Use and redistribute under their own terms, with their notices kept

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You may: share (copy and redistribute in any format) and adapt (remix, transform, build upon), for non-commercial purposes.

You must:

- Give attribution: credit "Competence Collective," link to the licence (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc/4.0/>), and say if you made changes.
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EVERYDAY QUESTIONS (OUR READING; COUNSEL DECIDES)

SITUATION	OUR READING
A public school prints the kit for classes	Non-commercial: yes
A library or youth group runs sessions free of charge	Non-commercial: yes
A PTA hands out family letters at a free event	Non-commercial: yes
A district charges students a materials fee that covers only print cost	Likely fine, but ask. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]
A consultant charges a fee to deliver Hackles lessons	Probably commercial. Ask for permission
A company sells a workbook built from the lessons	Commercial. Needs permission
A school translates a letter into another language	Allowed with attribution and a "changes made" note. You are responsible for the translation. Have a qualified translator check hotline and disclosure wording
A school edits a lesson	Allowed under CC BY-NC. Say you edited it. Do not present it as the publisher's version. Re-review any safety content you change
Posting the PDFs on the district website	Allowed. You own the accessibility of what you post
Putting the kit on a teacher-marketplace site	The marketplace's terms may conflict with NC. Check them. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]

Brand assets

THE NAME, LOGOS, MASCOT and artwork are not licensed under Creative Commons. A Creative Commons licence does not grant trademark rights. [VERIFY with counsel] The kit's rule is simple: print and share them exactly as published for classroom and family use. If you want to recolour the mascot, put it on a T-shirt, make a poster for a paid event, or use the name for your own program, ask first. [CONTACT: to be added]

Name status. The name "Hackles" has not been cleared for trademark. A 2001 to 2004 webcomic used the name, and the domain hackles.org is tied to it, not to Competence Collective. If the name changes after counsel's clearance, expect updated files. Keep your own copies labelled with the version and date you downloaded. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]

Ownership chain. The publisher's checklist still lists as open a confirmation that Competence Collective owns or has licensed all text and art, including any contractor and AI-assisted material. Counsel has not confirmed this. A district that needs that assurance should ask for it in writing before relying on the licence for anything beyond routine classroom use. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]

Open-source and third-party components

COMPONENT	WHERE IT APPEARS	LICENCE	NOTES
Fraunces (variable font, regular and italic)	Reader, Lab, printed design	SIL OFL 1.1, Copyright 2018 The Fraunces Project Authors	Unmodified font files with notice kept
Source Serif 4 (variable, regular and italic)	Reader, Lab	SIL OFL 1.1, Copyright 2014 The Source Serif 4 Project Authors	Same
Caveat (variable)	Reader, Lab	SIL OFL 1.1, Copyright 2014 The Caveat Project Authors	Same
Special Elite (regular)	Reader	Apache License 2.0	Licence text in Appendix. Keep the notice
Kit-authored scripts (Reader, Lab, Slides, site)	Reader, Lab, Slides	Part of the kit. Scripts are authored by the kit's maintainers. Confirm the licence for code with counsel. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]	No third-party JavaScript libraries are loaded
Python libraries used to build the kit (reportlab, python-docx, python-pptx, openpyxl)	Build tools only, not shipped	Their own licences	Not distributed to schools. [VERIFY if you redistribute the tools]

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[VERIFY against the licence texts in the Appendix]

Marking your copies

WHEN YOU ADAPT OR reprint, put this near the front: "Adapted from Hackles by Competence Collective, CC BY-NC 4.0 (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc/4.0/>). Changes were made by [your school]. This version has not been reviewed or endorsed by Competence Collective."

What we cannot attest

- Counsel has not reviewed the licence choice, the two-layer wording, or the open ownership-chain item.
- Whether AI-assisted artwork or text is copyrightable, and whether the generators' terms permit open licensing, is unresolved. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]
- Whether the publisher will extend written permissions for brand uses. No permission process exists yet.